Activity 1: Privacy-Safe Wearable Wellness Pilot

Learning outcome: LO1 Objective: Apply legislative and ethical requirements to a workplace wellness technology decision Expected output: One-page pilot decision, annotated data-flow map and privacy/equity risk register Primary source: https://www.pdpc.gov.sg/overview-of-pdpa/the-legislation/personal-data-protection-act/data-protection-obligations

Goal

Assess whether a voluntary wearable pilot can address a defined employee need without creating surveillance, exclusion or unsafe data use.

Real-world scenario

Singapore's PDPA sets obligations including accountability, notification, consent, purpose limitation, accuracy, protection, retention limitation, transfer limitation and applicable access/correction rights. These obligations shape the design of employer-sponsored wellbeing data flows.

MarinaLink Logistics, a fictional Singapore employer with 640 office and shift employees, is considering voluntary wearables after staff reported fatigue and low movement. The vendor proposes individual dashboards for managers and a team leaderboard.

Evidence boundary

Public case facts and fictional learner data must never be mixed. Every numerical or organisational training input is labelled as an assumption.

Training assumptions / guardrails

- MarinaLink Logistics, all workforce figures and vendor terms are fictional training inputs.
- The proposed device records steps, heart rate, sleep estimates, location during challenges and a user identifier.
- Participation is advertised as voluntary, but line managers will distribute devices and see individual dashboards under the draft plan.
- Thirty per cent of shift staff share or do not regularly use a compatible smartphone; some employees cannot safely pursue step targets.

Questions

1. What decision purpose is necessary and proportionate, and which proposed fields are excessive?
2. Where could power imbalance undermine voluntariness or trust?
3. Which privacy, accessibility and fairness controls are pilot gates?
4. Should the pilot proceed, proceed conditionally or stop-and what evidence supports the decision?

Detailed activity procedure

Step 1: Frame the decision

Write one measurable employee need and one pilot decision. Exclude performance management, diagnosis and productivity surveillance from scope.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 2: Map the data flow

Map collection, device/app processing, vendor storage, employer access, reporting, transfer, retention and deletion. Name the responsible party at every handoff.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 3: Classify necessity

For each data field, record purpose, necessity, sensitivity and the least-intrusive alternative. Remove any field without a defensible need.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 4: Test voluntariness

Examine recruitment, incentives, manager involvement and the non-participant experience. Redesign the opt-in so refusal has no employment disadvantage.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 5: Assess equity

Use the employee personas to identify device, disability, language, shift and health barriers. Provide equivalent non-device participation pathways.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 6: Design controls

Specify notice, consent where applicable, access roles, aggregation threshold, security, vendor terms, retention, deletion, breach response and complaint route.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 7: Set pilot gates

Define readiness, participation, trust, access, incident and outcome measures. Add a stop trigger for privacy, safety or inequity concerns.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Step 8: Make the decision

Recommend proceed, conditional proceed or stop. State residual risks, accountable owner, review date and evidence needed before scale.

Checkpoint: Record the evidence, calculation or decision produced in this step.

Deliverable

One-page pilot decision, annotated data-flow map and privacy/equity risk register

Acceptance criteria

The submission defines a necessary purpose, minimises fields, removes manager access to individual data, offers a genuine alternative, specifies reporting thresholds and assigns every residual risk to an owner and gate.

Reflection and debrief questions

1. Which assumption changed your recommendation most, and why?
2. What evidence would you request before relying on the result?

3. Which stakeholder owns the next decision or mitigation?
4. Which review trigger or future exercise should follow?

Source note

Source accessed 16 August 2026:
https://www.pdpc.gov.sg/overview-of-pdpa/the-legislation/personal-data-protection-act/data-protection-obligations